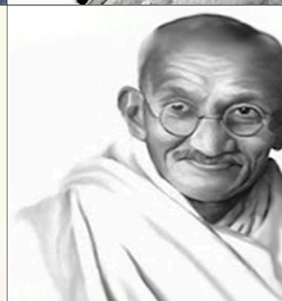
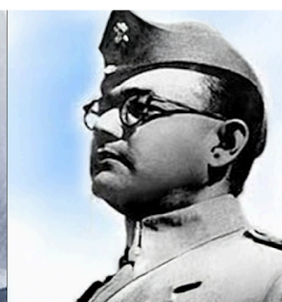


General Knowledge

Modern History

STUDY NOTES

Expansion of British East Indian Company
Anglo-Maratha Wars



Anglo-Maratha Wars



First Anglo-Maratha War (1775–1782)

- The First Anglo-Maratha War was fought between the British East India Company and the Maratha Empire in India.
- The war started with the Treaty of Surat and ended with the Treaty of Salbai. In 1772 after the death of Madhavrao Peshwa, his brother Narayanrao became Peshwa of the Maratha Empire.
- Narayanrao was assassinated by his palace guards in August 1773, and his uncle Raghunathrao became Peshwa.
- Although, Narayanrao's wife, Gangabai, gave birth to a posthumous son, who was the legal heir to the throne. The newborn infant was named 'Sawai' Madhavrao. Twelve Maratha chiefs, known as the Baarbhai and led by Nana Phadnavis, directed an effort to install the infant as the new Peshwa and to rule in his name as direct.
- Raghunathrao, not willing to give up his position of power, sought help from the British at Bombay and signed the Treaty of Surat on 6 March 1775. According to the treaty, Raghunathrao ended the territories of Salsette and Bassein (Vasai) to the British, along with part of the revenues from Surat and Bharuch districts. In return, the British pledge to provide Raghunathrao with 2,500 soldiers.
- The Treaty of Purandhar annulled that of Surat, Raghunathrao was pensioned and his cause rejected, but the revenues of Salsette and Broach districts were maintained by the British.

- The Bombay government rejected this new treaty and gave decline to Raghunath rao. But by granting the French a port on the West coast In 1777 Nana Phadnavis disobey his treaty with the Calcutta Council.
- The English denied by sending a force towards Pune.
- This led the British to send a force towards Pune. There was a battle at Wadgaon near following the treaty between France and the Poona Government in 1776, the Bombay Government decided to invade and reinstate Raghoba and sent a force under Col. Egerton reached Khopoli and made its way between the Western Ghats at Bhore Ghat and onwards toward Karla, and reached on 4 Jan.
- Finally the British were pressurized to retreat back to Wadgaon but were soon surrounded. The British give up and were forced to sign the Treaty of Wadgaon on 16 Jan. 1779, a victory for the Marathas.
- There was a series of battles and in the end of which the Treaty of Salbai was signed in 1782. This ended the first Anglo-Maratha war.

Results of first Anglo Maratha War

- The East India Company refuted Salsette and Broach.
- It also acquired a guarantee from the Marathas that they would retake their possessions in the Deccan from Hyder Ali of Mysore.
- The Marathas also agreed that they would not grant any more territories to the French.
- Raghunathrao was to given a pension of Rs.3 lakh every year.
- All territories taken by the British after the Treaty of Purandhar were given up back to the maratha.

Second Anglo-Maratha War (1803 – 1805)

- After Tipu Sultan's Mysore was seized by the British in 1799, the Marathas were the only major power left outside of British domination. At that time, the Maratha Confederacy comprises of five major chiefs, the Peshwas at Pune, the Gaekwads at Baroda, and the Holkars at Indore, the Scindias at Gwalior, and the Bhonsle's at Nagpur.
- There was an internal argument among themselves. Bajirao II (son of Raghunathrao) was bitter foe of Raghunathrao.
- In the Battle of Poona in 1802, Yashwantrao Holkar, the chief of the Holkars of Indore beat the Peshwas and the Scindias.
- Bajirao II sought British defence and signed the Treaty of Bassein with them.
- As per this treaty, he ended territory to the British and agreed to the maintenance of British troops there. The Scindias and the Bhonsle's did not accept this treaty and this resulted in the second Anglo-Maratha war in central India in 1803.
- The Holkars also joined the battle in opposition to the English at a later stage.

Result of the Second Anglo Maratha War-

- In the end, all the Maratha forces were defeated by the British in these battles.

- In 1803 The Scindias signed the Treaty of Surji-Anjangaon, through which the British got the territories of Rohtak, Ganga-Yamuna Doab, Gurgaon, Delhi Agra region, Broach, some districts in Gujarat, parts of Bundelkhand, and Ahmadnagar fort.
- In 1803 The Bhonsle's signed the Treaty of Deogaon, as per the English acquired Cuttack, Balasore, and the area west of Wardha River.
- The Holkars signed the Treaty of Rajghat in 1805 according to which they left Tonk, Bundi.

Third Anglo-Maratha War (1817 - 1818)

- The Third Anglo-Maratha War began with an invasion of the Maratha territory by British East India Company troops, though the British were outnumbered, the Maratha army was wiped out.
- British victories were swift, resulting in the loss of Maratha independence the breakup of the Maratha Empire.
- The Peshwa lost the battles of Khadki and Koregaon. The Peshwa was eventually caught and placed on a small estate at Bithur in Kanpur. Most of his territory was captured and became part of the Bombay Presidency.
- Bhonsle was defeated in the battle of Sitabuldi and also Holkar in the battle of Mahidpur. The northern portion of Bhonsle's premises in and around Nagpur, along with the Peshwa's territories in Bundelkhand, were annexed by British India as the Saugor and Nerbudda Territories.
- After the second Anglo-Maratha war, the Marathas, who lost their prestige made one last attempt to rebuild their former prestige.
- They wanted to recapture all their old possessions from the English.
- They were also unhappy with the British residents' intervention in their internal matters.
- The chief reason for this war was the British conflict with the Pindaris with whom the British suspected were being protected by the Marathas.
- The Maratha chiefs Peshwa Bajirao II, Malharrao Holkar, and Mudhoji II Bhonsle found a united front against the English.
- Daulat Rao Shinde, the fourth major Maratha chief was forced diplomatically to do not involve But the British victory was swift.

Results of third Anglo Maratha war-

- The Treaty of Gwalior was signed in 1817 between Shinde and the British, despite that he had not been involved in the war. According to the treaty, Shinde gave up Rajasthan to the British.
- The Rajas of Rajputana remained the Princely States till 1947 after receiving British sovereignty.
- The Treaty of Mandasor was signed between the British and the Holkar chief. An infant was set down on the throne under British guardianship.

- In 1818 the Peshwa surrendered. He was overthrown and pensioned off to a small estate in Bithur in Kanpur. Most of the parts of his territory became part of the Bombay Presidency. And Nana Saheb, his adopted son, became one of the leaders of the Revolt of 1857 at Kanpur.
- An obscure successor of Chhatrapati Shivaji was placed as the ceremonial head of the Maratha Confederacy at Satara.
- This was one of the last major wars fought and won by the British company. With this, the British taken most parts of India barring Punjab and Sindh directly or indirectly.

War	Duration	Key Figures	Cause	Outcome	Treaty
First Anglo-Maratha War	1775–1782	- Raghunathrao (Maratha faction) - Warren Hastings (British)	British support for Raghunathrao's claim to the Maratha throne, leading to tension within Maratha Empire	Stalemate; British fail to gain significant territory	Treaty of Salbai (1782)
Second Anglo-Maratha War	1803–1805	Arthur Wellesley (British) - Daulat Scindia and Yashwant Holkar (Maratha)	Internal conflict within the Maratha Empire; British took advantage to expand influence	Marathas defeated; loss of key territories to British	Treaties of Bassein (1802) and Surji-Anjangaon (1803)
Third Anglo-Maratha War	1817–1818	- Lord Hastings (British) - Peshwa Baji Rao II (Maratha)	Maratha resistance to British expansion; Peshwa Baji Rao II sought to regain autonomy	British victory; end of Maratha Empire; full British control	Annexation; no formal treaty